

USER GUIDE

How to Use FlowLeads

A Practical Guide for Running Your Business - No Tech Skills Needed

Everything you need to connect WhatsApp, manage your customers, and send messages to them - written step by step, using the exact buttons and screens you will actually see.

Prepared for: Okezie Collington

Date: August 8, 2026

App: flowleadsapp.netlify.app

Companion document: FlowLeads Technical Manual

Contents

1. Before You Start	3
2. Creating Your Account	4
3. Logging In	5
4. Connecting Your WhatsApp Number	6
5. Adding and Organizing Your Contacts	7
6. Chatting With Customers	8
7. Creating Message Templates	9
8. Sending a Mass Message (Broadcast Campaign)	10
9. Scheduling Messages for Later	11
10. Setting Up Email Sending	12
11. Inviting Your Team	13
12. Staying Safe: WhatsApp Ban-Prevention Rules	14
13. Daily Use Checklist	15
14. Troubleshooting	16
15. Quick Word Reference	17

Tip: You do not have to read this front to back. Set up your account with Sections 1-3, then jump straight to whichever section matches what you are trying to do.

Before You Start

FlowLeads is a tool that helps you manage your WhatsApp and email conversations with customers in one place, instead of scrolling through your personal phone. This guide assumes zero technical background - if you can use WhatsApp and send an email, you can use FlowLeads.

What you will need before you begin

- **A phone with WhatsApp installed** - the number you already use (or a dedicated business number) - you'll link it to FlowLeads by scanning a QR code, the same way you'd link WhatsApp Web.
- **A working email address** - used to create your FlowLeads account and receive notifications.
- **Your customer list (optional)** - if you already have a spreadsheet of customer names and phone numbers, you can import it in one go - see Section 5.

What FlowLeads is good for

- **Keeping every customer conversation in one place** - instead of one owner's personal phone that nobody else can access.
- **Sending one message to many customers at once** - a sale announcement, a reminder, a restock alert, without copying and pasting to each person.
- **Never losing a lead** - every contact is saved with notes, tags, and a stage (New, Contacted, Qualified, Won, Lost) so you always know where things stand.
- **Letting your team share the workload** - invite staff so more than one person can reply to customers, without sharing your personal phone.

Creating Your Account

Do this once, when you first start using FlowLeads.

- 1 **Go to the sign-up page** - open flowleadsapp.netlify.app in your browser and click "Sign up".
- 2 **Fill in your name** - this is just your own name, shown to your teammates later.
- 3 **Fill in your email and choose a password** - use an email you check regularly - this is also where account notifications go.
- 4 **Enter your team name** - this is your business name, e.g. "Acme Traders". It becomes what your account is called, and what teammates see when they join.
- 5 **Click "Create account"** - you'll be taken straight into the app - no email confirmation wait, no setup wizard.

WHAT IS A "TEAM"?

In FlowLeads, a "team" simply means your business account. Everyone you invite (Section 11) joins your team and shares the same contacts, chats, and templates. You do not need a team to use FlowLeads alone - it is just you, until you choose to invite someone.

Logging In

Every time after your first sign-up, you will come back to FlowLeads through the login page.

- 1 **Go to flowleadsapp.netlify.app** - you'll land on the login screen automatically if you're not already signed in.
- 2 **Enter your email and password** - the same ones you used when creating your account.
- 3 **Click "Log in"** - you'll land on your Contacts page.

FlowLeads keeps you logged in on that browser until you deliberately click "Sign out" (found at the bottom of the left-hand menu) - you will not be asked to log in again every visit.

SECTION 4

Connecting Your WhatsApp Number

This is the most important setup step - do this before anything else.

FlowLeads sends and receives WhatsApp messages through a number you personally link to it, exactly like linking WhatsApp Web or WhatsApp Desktop. You can connect up to 3 numbers to one FlowLeads account - handy if you have separate numbers for Sales and Support, for example.

- 1 **Open "WhatsApp Accounts"** - in the left-hand menu.
- 2 **Click "Connect another number"** - optionally give it a label first, like "Sales" or "Support", to help you tell numbers apart later.
- 3 **A QR code appears on screen** - open WhatsApp on the phone you want to connect, go to Settings > Linked Devices > Link a Device, and scan the code shown in FlowLeads.
- 4 **Wait for "Connected"** - once scanned, the status changes and you'll see the phone number appear.
- 5 **(Optional) Click "Sync History"** - this pulls your existing WhatsApp conversations into FlowLeads, so you are not starting from zero.

YOUR PHONE DOES NOT NEED TO STAY OPEN

Once connected, FlowLeads keeps working even if your phone's screen is off or the WhatsApp app is closed - similar to WhatsApp Web. The one thing to avoid is fully logging out of WhatsApp on that phone or removing the linked device, which disconnects FlowLeads too.

Adding and Organizing Your Contacts

The Contacts page is your customer list. Every lead or customer lives here, whether they came from WhatsApp, email, or you added them manually.

Adding one contact at a time

- 1 **Open "Contacts"** - in the left-hand menu.
- 2 **Click "+ Add contact"** - a form opens.
- 3 **Fill in name, phone, and/or email** - you need at least a phone number or an email - not necessarily both.
- 4 **Add tags (optional)** - short labels like "VIP" or "lead", separated by commas. Tags let you target messages later (Section 8).
- 5 **Choose a deal stage** - New, Contacted, Qualified, Won, or Lost - use this to track where each customer is in your sales process.
- 6 **Click "Save"** - the contact appears in your list immediately.

Adding many contacts at once (CSV import)

If you already keep a spreadsheet of customers, you do not need to retype it.

- 1 **Save your spreadsheet as a CSV file** - in Excel or Google Sheets, use "Save As" / "Download" and choose CSV format.
- 2 **Click "Import CSV"** - on the Contacts page.
- 3 **Match your spreadsheet's columns** - FlowLeads will ask you which column is the name, which is the phone number, and so on.
- 4 **Review and confirm** - if any numbers already exist in your contacts, FlowLeads flags them and lets you choose to skip or replace each one, so you never end up with duplicates.

Grouping contacts

Click the "Groups" tab on the Contacts page to create named groups, e.g. "Lagos customers" or "Wholesale buyers". Groups are useful when you want to send a mass message to a specific set of people rather than everyone - see Section 8.

Chatting With Customers

The Chats page is where you have real, one-on-one WhatsApp conversations - it works like WhatsApp itself, just inside FlowLeads.

- 1 **Open "Chats"** - in the left-hand menu.
- 2 **Search or pick a contact** - use the search box to find someone, or scroll the list - it is sorted with the most recent conversations at the top.
- 3 **Type your reply and send** - exactly like a normal WhatsApp conversation.
- 4 **New messages appear instantly** - if a customer messages you while you have Chats open, it appears on screen without needing to refresh.

Scheduling a single message for later

If you want a message to go out to one specific contact at a future time, such as a reminder tomorrow morning, you can queue it instead of sending it now.

- 1 **Open the conversation** - with the contact you want to message.
- 2 **Tick the "Schedule" option** - above the message box.
- 3 **Choose the date and time** - you want it sent.
- 4 **Send** - the message is queued - you'll see it listed as pending until it goes out, and you can cancel it any time before then.

Creating Message Templates

A template is a message you plan to reuse - a welcome message, a follow-up, a promotion. Instead of typing it fresh every time, you save it once and reuse it forever, including for mass messages (Section 8).

- 1 **Open "Templates"** - in the left-hand menu.
- 2 **Click "+ New template"** - give it a name so you can find it later, like "Welcome message".
- 3 **Choose the channel** - WhatsApp or Email - a template is written for one or the other.
- 4 **Write your message** - in the Message box.
- 5 **Personalize it with a shortcode** - type `{{name}}` anywhere in the message and FlowLeads automatically replaces it with each customer's actual name when it sends - "Hi `{{name}}`, thanks for your order!" becomes "Hi Amaka, thanks for your order!" for each person.
- 6 **Save** - the template is now available to use in the Chats page or in a mass-messaging campaign.

Sending a Mass Message (Broadcast Campaign)

This is how you message many customers at once - a restock alert, a sale, a holiday greeting - without sending them one by one. FlowLeads calls this a "campaign."

Create a template first (Section 7) - you will need one before you can start a campaign.

- 1 **Open "Mass Messaging"** - in the left-hand menu, and click "New campaign".
- 2 **Choose the channel** - WhatsApp or Email.
- 3 **Pick which connected number or email account to send from** - if you have more than one connected.
- 4 **Choose your template** - the message that will be sent.
- 5 **Choose who receives it, under "Send to"** - All contacts, By tag (e.g. everyone tagged "VIP"), or By group, a group you created in Section 5.
- 6 **(Optional) Schedule it for later** - tick the schedule box and choose a future date/time instead of sending immediately.
- 7 **(Optional) Attach an image or PDF, or add a link** - these get included with the message.
- 8 **Click "Create campaign" or "Schedule campaign"** - and FlowLeads takes it from there.

What happens after you hit send

FlowLeads does not blast every message at once - it deliberately spaces messages out over time, a few seconds apart, with a daily limit, to protect your WhatsApp number from being flagged as spam by WhatsApp. See Section 12 for why this matters. You can watch the campaign's progress, and pause or resume it at any time, from the Mass Messaging page.

Scheduling Messages for Later

FlowLeads lets you schedule two different things ahead of time - it is worth knowing the difference:

What you're scheduling	Where to do it	Goes to
A single message	Chats page (Section 6)	One specific contact
A mass campaign	Mass Messaging page (Section 8)	Everyone matching your chosen audience

YOUR PHONE OR LAPTOP CAN BE OFF

Scheduled messages and campaigns are sent from FlowLeads' own servers, not your personal device. You can schedule something for 6am and switch your phone off overnight - it will still go out on time, as long as your WhatsApp connection (Section 4) stays linked.

Setting Up Email Sending

Besides WhatsApp, FlowLeads can send email campaigns too, through your own existing email account (Gmail, Yahoo, a company email, etc.), not a generic FlowLeads address.

- 1 **Open "Account"** - in the left-hand menu, and find "Email accounts".
- 2 **Click to add an email account** - and give it a label, e.g. "Support".
- 3 **Enter your email provider's sending settings** - labeled "SMTP host" and "Port" - your email provider (Gmail, Yahoo, etc.) publishes these; searching "[your provider] SMTP settings" will give you the exact values.
- 4 **Enter your email username and password** - for Gmail/Yahoo this is often a special "app password" rather than your normal login password - your provider's account security settings will let you generate one.
- 5 **Enter the "From" address** - the email address your customers will see as the sender.
- 6 **Save** - this account is now available to send email campaigns from, the same way as WhatsApp in Section 8.

If this step feels technical, it is the one part of FlowLeads that briefly borrows a term from your email provider - SMTP just means "the settings for sending email." Your provider's help page will have the exact numbers to copy in.

Inviting Your Team

If you have staff who should also be able to reply to customers, invite them to your account instead of sharing your own login.

- 1 **Open "Account"** - in the left-hand menu.
- 2 **Find "Invite a teammate"** - enter their email address and choose a role.
- 3 **Click to send the invite** - FlowLeads gives you a sign-up link to share with them directly.
- 4 **Share that link with your teammate** - they create their own login and land inside your team automatically, seeing the same contacts, chats, and templates as you.

Everyone on your team shares one set of contacts and conversations - it is one shared business inbox, not separate accounts per person.

Staying Safe: WhatsApp Ban-Prevention Rules

Read this before running your first big campaign.

WhatsApp actively watches for numbers that suddenly send lots of messages to people who have not messaged first, and can temporarily or permanently ban a number that looks like it is spamming. FlowLeads has built-in protections, but a few habits on your side matter too.

- **Let FlowLeads pace your messages** - do not try to work around the built-in delay - it exists specifically to keep your number safe.
- **Warm up a brand-new number gradually** - a number you just connected should start with smaller campaigns before sending to hundreds of people at once.
- **Message people who know you** - customers who have messaged you before, or opted in, are much less likely to report you than cold contacts.
- **Avoid identical messages to huge numbers of strangers** - this is the single biggest trigger for a WhatsApp ban - use tags/groups (Section 5) to keep your audience relevant.
- **Keep an eye on the Mass Messaging dashboard** - if a campaign shows a lot of failures, pause it and check your WhatsApp connection before continuing.

Daily Use Checklist

A simple routine for using FlowLeads day to day, once you are set up.

- **Check "Chats"** - for new customer replies and respond.
- **Add new leads to "Contacts"** - as they come in, with a tag and deal stage.
- **Move deal stages forward** - as conversations progress, New to Contacted to Qualified to Won/Lost, so your pipeline stays accurate.
- **Use "Mass Messaging"** - for announcements, following the pacing guidance in Section 12.
- **Check "WhatsApp Accounts"** - occasionally, to confirm your number still shows "Connected".

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
The QR code will not scan / connect	Make sure the phone's camera and WhatsApp are both up to date, and that you are scanning from WhatsApp's own "Link a Device" screen, not a regular QR scanner app.
WhatsApp shows "Disconnected"	Open WhatsApp on the linked phone and check Settings > Linked Devices - if FlowLeads is not listed, go to Section 4 and reconnect.
A campaign says "Paused"	Open Mass Messaging - a campaign auto-pauses if it hits its daily sending limit, and can be resumed the next day, or manually once reviewed.
A new contact did not save	Check that you entered at least a phone number or an email - FlowLeads requires one of the two.
I imported a CSV and got a duplicates warning	This is expected and safe - FlowLeads is flagging phone numbers that already exist so you can choose to skip or replace them, not creating duplicates automatically.
I cannot see the "Admin" menu item	That is expected - it is only visible to the platform owner's account, not regular business accounts.

Quick Word Reference

A short list of the FlowLeads-specific words used in this guide.

Team

Your business account inside FlowLeads - everyone you invite shares the same team.

Contact

One customer or lead saved in your Contacts list.

Tag

A short label you attach to a contact, e.g. "VIP", to group and target them later.

Deal stage

Where a contact sits in your sales process: New, Contacted, Qualified, Won, or Lost.

Group

A named set of contacts you build yourself, used to target a mass message.

Template

A saved, reusable message - written once, sent many times.

Shortcode ({{name}})

A placeholder inside a template that is automatically replaced with each contact's real name when sent.

Campaign

A mass message sent to many contacts at once, following your chosen audience and schedule.

Broadcast

Another word for a campaign - one message, sent to many people.

Connected (WhatsApp status)

Your WhatsApp number is actively linked to FlowLeads and able to send/receive.

SMTP

Your email provider's sending settings, needed once to connect an email account for email campaigns.

